

Special Educational Needs Coordinator (SENCo)

The SENCo plays a central role in shaping and overseeing the provision for pupils with special educational needs and disabilities (SEND). Working in close collaboration with the Assistant Principal for SEND/Inclusion, senior leaders, and teaching staff, the SENCo is responsible for the strategic direction, development, and daily coordination of SEND provision, with the ultimate aim of improving outcomes for all learners with additional needs.

Core Purpose

- Lead the strategic development of the primary academy's SEND provision
- Oversee the day-to-day implementation of SEND strategies across the primary school.
- Monitor, evaluate, and enhance the achievement and progress of pupils with SEND.
- Support staff in delivering inclusive and effective teaching in the primary classroom.

Key Areas of Responsibility

1. Strategic Direction of SEND Provision

- Support the senior leadership team and governors in the formulation and review of the primary academy's SEND strategy.
- Ensure SEND priorities are integrated into the primary school development plan.
- Analyse pupil data and evaluate the impact of interventions to inform future planning.
- Provide informed recommendations on resource allocation to support SEND outcomes.
- Liaise effectively with parents, external agencies, and other schools (particularly transition from early years settings) to ensure cohesive provision and continuity of support.

2. Teaching and Learning

- Promote effective teaching strategies tailored to pupils with SEND.
- Collaborate with staff to identify learning needs and ensure appropriate assessment, planning, and review processes are in place.
- Support the implementation and monitoring of personalised targets, including IEPs and other support plans.
- Interpret specialist assessment data to refine and personalise teaching approaches.

- Work across teams to maintain high expectations and equitable learning experiences for all primary pupils.
- Advise on teaching tools, resources, and technologies to support specific needs.

3. Leadership and Staff Development

- Provide expert guidance and support to staff to ensure effective inclusive practice.
- Contribute to whole-school professional development, including INSET sessions and targeted training relevant to primary SEND.
- Maintain regular communication with leadership and governors regarding the evaluation of SEND provision.

4. Management of Resources

- Advise on the effective use of SEND funding and staffing.
- Coordinate and maintain SEND-specific resources and evaluate their impact on pupil progress.
- Ensure clear and accurate documentation is completed and shared appropriately with stakeholders.

5. Annual Reviews and Statutory Duties

- Coordinate the full schedule of Annual Reviews for pupils with Education, Health and Care Plans (EHCPs).
- Attend and, where appropriate, chair Annual Review meetings in collaboration with families and professionals.



Person Specification – SENCo

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes expected for the role of Special Educational Needs Coordinator (SENCo).

Qualifications and Training

Essential:

- A degree in a relevant subject area.
- Qualified Teacher Status (QTS), recognised by the Department for Education.
- Evidence of recent and ongoing professional development related to SEND or inclusion.

Desirable:

- National Award for SEN Coordination (or a willingness to complete this within the statutory timeframe).
- Further training or accreditation in areas such as Autism Spectrum Disorders (ASD), Speech and Language, SEMH, or Dyslexia.
- Professional development linked to leadership, coaching, or mentoring.

Experience

Essential:

- Direct experience supporting pupils with a range of special educational needs within a primary school setting.
- Proven ability to work effectively with colleagues, parents, external professionals, and multi-agency teams.
- Experience of using assessment to identify needs and inform personalised provision in the primary classroom.
- Track record of supporting improved outcomes for pupils with SEND in a primary setting.
- Experience of contributing to staff development and sharing inclusive practice in primary education.

Desirable:

- Previous experience as SENCo or Inclusion Lead in a primary school.
- Familiarity with coordinating or chairing Annual Reviews and supporting the implementation of EHCPs.
- Participation in whole-school improvement work linked to inclusion, pastoral support or SEND in a primary setting.

Professional Knowledge, Skills and Understanding

Essential:

- Thorough knowledge of the SEND Code of Practice and relevant legislation.
- Ability to interpret and use data to evaluate impact and plan future provision in the primary school.
- Strong understanding of effective strategies for supporting diverse learning needs in the primary classroom.
- Confident communicator, both verbally and in writing, with a range of audiences, including parents and carers of young children.
- Experience of developing and reviewing Individual Education Plans (IEPs), support plans or equivalent, adapted for the primary setting.

Desirable:

- Experience using digital systems to support SEND provision.
- Understanding of whole-school approaches to trauma-informed or restorative practices in a primary context.
- Experience delivering training or workshops to colleagues or parents in a primary setting.
- Knowledge of accessibility planning and equality duty requirements in primary education.

Leadership and Management

Essential:

- Capable of analysing pupil-level and whole-school data to identify trends and inform planning in the primary school.
- Understanding of how to ensure high-quality curriculum provision that meets the needs of all learners in the primary classroom.
- Able to model integrity, build credibility, and form positive professional relationships with primary staff and families.

Desirable:

- Involvement in school self-evaluation or inspection processes relating to SEND in a primary school.
- Experience leading cross-school initiatives or contributing to Trust-wide SEND development in primary education.
- Participation in local authority or national SEND forums, working groups, or networks focused on primary SEND.

Personal Qualities and Attributes

The role requires an individual who is **approachable, empathetic, and professional** in all interactions. A strong **commitment to inclusion** and the **belief that every pupil can thrive** lies at the heart of their practice. They will demonstrate **resilience** and **adaptability**, particularly when managing complex or high-pressure situations, and possess a **calm, solution-focused approach**. Strong **organisational skills** are essential, as is the ability to balance strategic thinking with attention to detail. The SENCo should be **confident in supporting and influencing colleagues**, with the interpersonal skills to build positive relationships across the school community. A **reflective and open mindset** is important, alongside a willingness to seek out opportunities for **continuous learning**.

Ideally, they will also bring a track record of motivating others, implementing effective systems, and helping to shape a culture of collaboration and high expectations.

Safeguarding of Students and Duty of Care

All staff, regardless of role, level of seniority and location, have a responsibility to ensure the highest levels of safeguarding and promoting the welfare of our pupils, and we expect all our staff and volunteers to share this commitment. We must collectively create an environment where children feel safe to learn, play, and grow. Children should feel comfortable in their surroundings and know that they can approach any responsible adult with any problems or concerns.

All staff must be able to identify any children who are at risk of harm, and know the characteristics of abuse or neglect. If you suspect or confirm harm then it's essential you know what actions to take.

Annual safeguarding training is offered to all staff at Leigh Academies Trust, and it is the staff member's responsibility to be aware of the most up to date guidance documented in the [Keeping Children Safe in Education document](#) ([Department of Education](#)).

Notes

The job description allocates duties and responsibilities but does not direct the particular amount of time to be spent on carrying them out and no part of it may be so construed. This job description is not necessarily a comprehensive definition of the post. It will be reviewed at least once a year and may be subject to modification or amendment at any time after consultation with the holder of the post.

